

Research Interests

Fields: Economics of Education, Behavioral Economics

Methods: Experimental Economics, Applied Microeconometrics

Current Position and Affiliations

Postdoctoral Researcher in Behavioral Economics, Düsseldorf Institute for Competition Economics (DICE), Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf Düsseldorf, Germany since Jun 2026

Affiliate, Behavioral Insights and Parenting Lab (BIP Lab), University of Chicago Chicago, USA

Affiliate, FAIR – The Choice Lab, NHH Norwegian School of Economics Bergen, Norway

Education

PhD in Economics, NHH Norwegian School of Economics, affiliated with FAIR Bergen, Norway Sep 2026

- **Dissertation:** Essays on Belief Formation in the Family
- **Supervisors:** Alexander W. Cappelen (primary) and Kjell G. Salvanes (secondary)
- **PhD Committee:** Mathias Philip Ekström, Ulf Zölitz, and Silke Anger

Research Stay, Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago Chicago, USA
Hosted by Ariel Kalil Sep 2023–Apr 2024

MSc in Economics, University of Mannheim Mannheim, Germany 2017–2019

BSc in Economics, University of Mannheim Mannheim, Germany 2013–2016

Publications

Economic Mobility Beliefs and Parental Investment: Experimental Evidence, with Mesmin Destin, Ivan A. Hernandez, Ariel Kalil, Rebecca M. Ryan, and David Silverman. *Economics Letters*, 267, 113090. 2026
[Published Version](#) 

Economic Mobility and Parents' Opportunity Hoarding, with Mesmin Destin, Ivan A. Hernandez, Ariel Kalil, Rebecca M. Ryan, and David Silverman. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America (PNAS)*, 121 (37), e2407230121. [Published Version](#) 

Working Papers

Biased Parental Beliefs: Experimental Evidence from Norway. [Draft](#) 

Parents' beliefs about their children's abilities shape parental behavior and decision-making. But do parents process information about their children's abilities objectively or in a biased way? I study this question in a large-scale lab-in-the-field experiment with Norwegian elementary school students and their parents ($N = 743$ parent-child pairs) to examine how parents update beliefs when receiving noisy signals about their child's performance in a cognitive (mathematics) or a non-cognitive (prosociality) skill. In *mathematics*, updating is symmetric, with parents being similarly responsive to both positive and negative signals. In *prosociality*, by contrast, parents update their beliefs more strongly to good signals but are significantly less responsive to negative signals. The asymmetry is particularly pronounced when signals are framed as reflecting parents' own traits. Following negative prosocial signals, parents engage in ex-post rationalization: they rate their child's effort and the relevance of the signals as lower. Survey evidence indicates that these domain differences stem from two factors: parents are better informed about their child's performance in mathematics, and they view prosociality as more central to their child's broader life success. Biased belief updating thus emerges when information is sparse and outcomes are ego-relevant, with important implications for how feedback is designed and delivered in educational contexts.

Parental Messages and Children's Confidence, with Kai Barron, Michela Carlana, and Oda Sund.

This paper studies how parents may curate the ego-relevant information children receive about themselves and how this information influences the beliefs and behavior of children. Using a lab-in-the-field experiment with Norwegian seventh-grade students and their parents, we show that parents send messages to their children that are systematically more favorable than parents' private beliefs. Children incorporate these messages into their self-assessments: receiving a parental message raises their posterior beliefs about their relative performance. This increase in confidence does not, however, affect immediate quiz performance or the domain in which children choose to compete. Parents send slightly more favorable messages when children receive them before rather than after the quiz and are more likely to explain these messages in terms of motivating the child, consistent with anticipated motivational benefits shaping what parents communicate. These findings show that beliefs about ourselves depend not only on how individuals process information, but also on how others curate the information they receive.

References

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Ariel Kalil

Daniel Levin Professor
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Conferences and Workshops

Bergen–Berlin Behavioural Economics Workshop; CESifo Area Conference on Economics of Education (<i>upcoming</i>); 18th Nordic Conference in Behavioral and Experimental Economics (<i>upcoming</i>); MPI / ECONtribute Workshop on Human Capital and Education (<i>upcoming</i>)	2026
FAIR–MPI Workshop in Behavioral Economics; 17th Nordic Conference in Behavioral and Experimental Economics; Advances with Field Experiments Conference; Narratives, Memory and Beliefs Workshop WZB–LMU; 4th Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business; Bergen–Berlin Behavioural Economics Workshop; International Symposium in Experimental Economics (iSEE), NYU Abu Dhabi	2025
NBER Economics of Mobility; FAIR–MPI Workshop in Behavioral Economics; Nordic PhD Workshop in the Economics of Education	2024
Rohit and Harvanit Kumar Conference on Early Childhood Development; Advances with Field Experiments Conference; 6th Experiments on Social Inequality Workshop	2023
HCEO/briq Summer School on Socioeconomic Inequality	2022

Grants and Funding

Professor Wilhelm Keilhaus Memorial Fund (2025) Funding received for attending academic conferences	EUR 2,500
Norges Bank's Fund for Economic Research (2025) Funding received for attending academic conferences	EUR 2,200
Professor Wilhelm Keilhaus Memorial Fund (2024) Funding received for "Biased Parental Beliefs: Experimental Evidence from Norway"	EUR 1,300
Diligentia Foundation for Empirical Research (2024) Funding received for "Parental Messages and Children's Confidence"	EUR 39,000
Research Council of Norway – Research Stay Abroad Funding (2024) Funding received for a research stay at the University of Chicago	EUR 22,500
Centre for Ethics and Economics (CEE) Grant (2023) Funding received for "Biased Parental Beliefs: Experimental Evidence from Norway"	EUR 2,800
Professor Wilhelm Keilhaus Memorial Fund (2023) Funding to support lab-in-the-field data collection	EUR 6,000

Teaching Experience

Seminar on Family Economics , Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf <i>Undergraduate (Bachelor) Level</i> , Instructor	Autumn/Winter 2026/2027
Experimental Economics , Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf <i>Graduate (Master) Level</i> , Teaching Assistant	Spring/Summer 2026
Behavioral Economics , NHH Norwegian School of Economics <i>Graduate (Master) Level</i> , Teaching Assistant	Spring 2025
Economics and Psychology , NHH Norwegian School of Economics <i>Undergraduate (Bachelor) Level</i> , Teaching Assistant	Autumn 2024
Competitive Strategy , NHH Norwegian School of Economics <i>Graduate (Master) Level</i> , Teaching Assistant	Spring 2023
Business Cycle Analysis , NHH Norwegian School of Economics <i>Graduate (Master) Level</i> , Teaching Assistant	2021–2022
Long-Term Macroeconomic Analysis , NHH Norwegian School of Economics <i>Graduate (Master) Level</i> , Teaching Assistant	Spring 2021

Research and Professional Experience

University Lecturer (50% position) , NHH Norwegian School of Economics	Bergen, Norway 2024–2025
Full-time Research Assistant (Predoc) for Prof. Dr. Teodora Boneva , University of Oxford	Oxford, UK 2019–2020
Research Assistant for Prof. Dr. Sebastian Findeisen , University of Mannheim	Mannheim, Germany 2018–2019
Research Assistant , Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW)	Mannheim, Germany 2015–2016
Research Assistant for Prof. Dr. Eckhard Janeba , University of Mannheim	Mannheim, Germany 2014–2015

Professional and Academic Service

- **Organizing:** DICE Research Seminar Autumn/Winter 2026, Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf (main organizer)
- **Supervision:** Co-supervision of Bachelor and Master Theses at Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf

Other Skills

- **Programming and software:** Python, Stata, R, oTree, Qualtrics, $\text{\LaTeX}$
- **Languages:** German (native), English (fluent), French (basic), Norwegian (basic), Latin

Personal Information

- **Citizenship:** German